

OMB Control No: 0970-0114

Expiration date: 03/31/2027

THE PAPERWORK REDUCTION ACT OF 1995 (Pub. L. 104–13)

The purpose of this information collection is the application for CCDF funds and provides ACF and the public with a description of, and assurance about, the States' and Territories' child care programs. Public reporting burden for this collection of information is estimated to average 150 hours per response, including the time for reviewing instructions, gathering, and maintaining the data needed, and completing the form. This is a mandatory collection of information (Pub. L. 113–186), and 42 U.S.C. 9858.

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**Appendix 1: Lead Agency Implementation Plan
for**

State/Territory Louisiana

FFY 2025 – 2027

Version: Initial Plan

Plan Status: Approved as of 2024-11-09 00:55:03 GMT

For each non-compliance, Lead Agencies must describe the following:

- **Action Steps:** List the action steps needed to correct the finding (e.g., update policy manual, legislative approval, IT system changes, etc.). For each action step list the:
 - o **Expected Completion Date:** List the expected completion date for the action step.
- **Overall Target Date for Compliance:** List date Lead Agency anticipates completing implementation, achieving full compliance with all aspects of the findings. (Note: Compliance will not be determined until the FFY 2025-2027 CCDF Plan is amended and approved).

EQUAL ACCESS:PAYMENT PRACTICES

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not pay all provider types prospectively or alternatively does not demonstrate that it is not a generally-accepted practice for all provider types, as required by 98.45(m)(1). (Plan Question 4.4.1a). Please note the Lead Agency has an approved waiver for this requirement through August 1, 2026.

Overall Target Completion Date: 08/01/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Begin work with current and new payments systems vendor, on steps needed to transition systems to prospective payments	09/30/2024
2	Finalize work with new payments systems vendor to ensure that requirements of new system, to be launched in 2025, are fully set up to provide prospective payments and to do so according to our payment schedule	12/31/2024
3	Bring proposed policy change to Early Childhood Care and Education Advisory Council for endorsement and state Board of Elementary and Secondary Education for approval	12/31/2024
4	Work with team managing current payment system to finalize and schedule a conversion period from payments after service provision to prospective payments	02/28/2025
5	Develop communications for the field, explaining the rollout of prospective payments, along with a timeline for various payments	03/31/2025
6	Policy change goes into final rule	04/30/2025
7	Test new payments system in development, to ensure payments continue prospectively	06/30/2025

EQUAL ACCESS:PAYMENT RATES

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency's payment rates for preschoolers in center-based care are not sufficient to ensure equal access, as required by 98.45(a). (Plan Question 4.3.2a)

Overall Target Completion Date: 08/01/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Analyze market rate survey and flag possible rate increases	06/30/2024
2	Prepare a cost estimation of increased expense of rate increase and expected impact on overall decrease in number of children to be served	01/31/2025
3	Plan stakeholder meetings to discuss upcoming proposed policy change	04/30/2025
4	Take proposed policy change to Early Childhood Care and Education Advisory Council for endorsement and state Board of Elementary and Secondary Education for approval	06/30/2025
5	Program new rates into payment system and test	09/30/2025
6	Policy change goes into final rule, Lead Agency conducts broader communications with the field	10/31/2025

EQUAL ACCESS:PROVIDER OPTIONS FOR PARENTS

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not provide grants or contracts for direct services for children with disabilities, as required by 98.30(b)(1). (Plan Question 4.5.1i). Please note the Lead Agency has an approved waiver for this requirement through August 1, 2026.

Overall Target Completion Date: 08/01/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Ask ACF-OCC and peer Lead Agency leaders for clarity about and examples of grants or contracts for direct services for children with disabilities at regional meetings and STAM	08/31/2024
2	Request from our regional office and ACF-OCC TA centers, on our monthly calls, technical assistance to better understand how other states are meeting or planning to meet this requirement, to help us in implementing a plan for Louisiana as well	09/30/2024
3	Begin consulting with stakeholders who specialize in serving the needs of young children with disabilities and their families, to begin considering what such grants or contracts would look like, where they might most be needed, and where young children with disabilities might best be served	04/30/2025
4	Work with the vendor that is building our updated data system, including our subsidy program application process and payments system, on the development of any necessary modules for the administration of grants or contracts for direct services for children with disabilities	09/30/2025
5	Begin piloting some grants or contracts for direct services for young children with disabilities	12/31/2025
6	Assess pilot implementation and make any needed adjustments	06/30/2026

EQUAL ACCESS:SUPPLY BUILDING STRATEGIES

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not adequately describe how they identify gaps in the supply of infant/toddler child care, as required by 98.16(x). (Plan Question 4.5.3ai)

Overall Target Completion Date: 08/01/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Ask regional office to request clarification regarding this finding, with which we disagree, and provide the regional office with further information about the Lead Agency process in this area	11/14/2024
2	Submit State Plan amendment for the pertinent State Plan response, to include additional needed description	01/31/2025